

Plateau-breaking guide with advanced techniques, refeed strategies, and mindset reset — Action Checklist

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DIAGNOSE YOUR PLATEAU TYPE

- ☐ **Diagnose Your Plateau:** Answer the five classification questions about weeks in deficit, hunger levels, gym performance, scale jumps, and sleep quality to identify your dominant plateau type.
- ☐ **Diagnose Your Plateau:** Write down your answers and look for patterns — if you answered yes to constant hunger and waking exhausted, your dominant plateau is likely hormonal.
- ☐ **Diagnose Your Plateau:** If your gym performance has plateaued or declined and you feel more sedentary outside workouts, your dominant plateau is neural adaptation requiring different interventions.
- ☐ **Diagnose Your Plateau:** When the scale jumps 1-3kg overnight after eating more carbs or changing sodium intake, recognize this as a water retention plateau, not actual fat gain.

CALCULATE YOUR TRUE METABOLIC RATE

- ☐ **Calculate Your Metabolism:** Multiply your current body weight in kg by 22 if you're female or 24 if you're male to estimate your baseline resting metabolic rate.
- ☐ **Calculate Your Metabolism:** Apply your activity multiplier to your RMR to determine your true maintenance calories, which have likely decreased since you started dieting.
- ☐ **Calculate Your Metabolism:** Subtract 300-500 calories from your recalculated maintenance to set an accurate deficit, accounting for metabolic adaptation that occurred during your weight loss.
- ☐ **Calculate Your Metabolism:** Compare your current calorie target to what you started with — if you've reduced intake significantly without recalculating, you may be eating at maintenance instead of deficit.

EXECUTE STRATEGIC INTERVENTIONS

- ☐ **Execute Interventions:** Plan a strategic refeed with 150-200% of your normal carbohydrate intake for 24-48 hours to elevate leptin and thyroid hormones and signal your body that starvation has ended.

 - ☐ **Execute Interventions:** Monitor your refeed carefully — a true refeed resets hormones and accelerates fat loss, while an uncontrolled binge simply adds calories without metabolic benefits.

 - ☐ **Execute Interventions:** After refeeding, return immediately to your calculated deficit on Monday rather than extending the higher eating period, since extended surplus undoes your caloric progress.

 - ☐ **Execute Interventions:** Implement the 48-hour plateau response system when the scale stalls for more than two weeks, using your plateau classification to choose the right intervention instead of guessing.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.